

Epson Stylus CX3100

Average performer

The Epson Stylus CX3100 is targeted at the SoHo user. It includes a printer and a flatbed scanner which doubles up as the copier, but the fax has been done away with. The interface is USB, so data transfer rate is not an issue.



The CX3100 is bulky and looks clumsy, but a potential buyer would be looking at cost, not looks. It features 48-bit colour depth scanning with an optical resolution of up to 9600 dpi. There's an LCD display and nine self-explanatory function buttons.

The CX3100 was an average performer, with average text printout time. The photo printout took long—399 seconds—the second slowest in this category. The text print quality wasn't too good in general, but it was better than the others in terms of minimum readable text size. The photo quality printing test gave a mixed bag of results: the CX3100 came in last in terms of time for high-resolution scanning; and though it was good in the tonal deviation test, it was mediocre in the colour uniformity and colour deviation tests. This MFD was the fastest in the entire category when it came to copying. The price-per-page for B&W pages works out to Rs 3.87, and to Rs. 4.43 for colour—more or less the same as the others.

The CX3100 is priced at Rs 8,395. Although it is not a top-notch performer, it definitely is above average in this category. If you're looking for a decent, economical MFD, the CX-3100 is a

Price: Rs 8,395
Pros: Fast copy speed
Cons: Expensive

Epson Stylus CX3100		B-	
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■

HP PSC 2110 all-in-one

Pocket-rocket scanner

The PSC 2110 all-in-one is intended to replace the ageing PSC 750. The design is more or less similar to that of its higher-end sibling, the HP 2210. There's no fax capabilities or memory card reader. The dimensions of the HP PSC 2110 are compact—it features a little one-line, barely-readable LCD display, and ten function buttons. There's also a nifty feature that lets you scan directly to your e-mail client.



The ink cartridges and the power and USB cables come bundled. This MFD can also work with PhotoRet IV technology, but you'll need to order a separate photo cartridge. The 2110 is an attractive option for users who need to take photo-quality printouts.

It took the longest of all for printing a text document. Photo printout time was average. On the quality front though, the 2110 gave crisp, high-quality printouts. It also scores in the scanning department—it was the fastest scanner of all, including the other HP devices we tested. It came in second in the document copying tests.

This product is another viable option for SoHo users, because it provides good printouts and quality scans. With solid performance across all categories, the HP 2110 provides value for money as well as a good price-to-performance ratio. The cost-per-page, for both B&W and colour, is slightly high, but not high enough to put off users willing to spend a little extra for quality.

Price: Rs 9,999
Pros: Good print quality
Cons: Mediocre scanning performance

HP PSC 2110 all-in-one		C	
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■

HP PSC 1210 all-in-one

A cheap solution

Don't be fooled by the appearance of the 1210—this all-in-one performs reasonably well. Its footprint is among the smallest of those of the devices we tested. The 1210 is aimed squarely at home users who are looking for more than just a printer.

The device can print, scan and copy A4-size documents. A press of a button beside an LED counter orders one to nine copies of a document, but you'll need to use the software control panel if you want 10 or more.



The device comes with print cartridges, and power and USB cables. It's a light-duty machine, with its duty cycle a very modest 1000 pages per month. Printing resolution is the lowest amongst all the MFDs we tested—just 2400 dpi. Connectivity also takes a hit, with only USB 1.1. There's no LCD display—you have a stick-on label identifying the eight buttons on the top left edge, for black or colour copy, scan, number of copies and so on.

Text print time was in line with that of the other printers. Photo print quality was no great shakes, but it was what one can expect of a low-end stand-alone printer—in fact, better. Scanning speed was good, while copying was slow. Scan quality was average overall, but bad in the dark region of the spectrum. Sensitivity to light shades was good.

The 1210 is the second-lowest priced device in this category, at Rs 5,999, it costs almost the same as a regular printer. If you want a really cheap printer-scanner combination, this is

Price: Rs 5,999
Pros: Simple to use
Cons: USB 1.1

HP PSC 1210 all-in-one		A	
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Ease of use	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	■ ■ ■ ■ ■